

Monday, 17 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Light drizzle 26° 20°	BIRMINGHAM Light drizzle 26° 17°	MANCHESTER Light rain 22° 16°	GLASGOW Heavy drizzle 18° 15°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

UK-made drones have reportedly struck military and industrial targets inside mainland Russia for the first time.

This marks a significant development in the ongoing conflict, with the drones hitting key sites. The attacks represent an escalation in the use of British technology in the region.

CONFLICT · UK
- 2

Reform UK is proposing a massive £50 billion cut to the welfare bill, which could see significant changes to disability payments for millions.

The party, if elected, plans to replace the current Personal Independence Payment system. This move would impact a large number of people currently receiving disability support.

POLITICS · UK
- 3

There have been multiple fatalities and four people injured after a car drove on the wrong side of the M9 motorway in County Kildare.

The tragic collision happened in the early hours of Sunday morning. Emergency services were at the scene, and investigations are now underway.

TRAGEDY · IRELAND
- 4

A murder inquiry has been launched in Wakefield after a man died following a dog attack.

Police are appealing for two people who stopped to help the victim to come forward. The incident has shocked the local community.

CRIME · UK
- 5

A baby bank is warning that some parents are resorting to 'watering down baby milk' due to the rising cost of essentials.

Moorside Baby Bank says families are turning to unsafe practices to make ends meet. This highlights the severe impact of the cost of living crisis on vulnerable families.

COST OF LIVING · UK

What's coming up

1 Ariana Grande's highly anticipated tour has arrived in the UK, with the star playing the first of ten dates in London.

Fans are excited to see her perform after she announced plans to 'step back' from public life following these shows. It's a big moment for her British fans.

ON AIR – Are you going to see Ariana Grande on tour, or have you got tickets for another big gig coming up?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

2 Sadie Sink and Adam Driver are set to join the Marvel Cinematic Universe in a new X-Men movie.

They'll be starring alongside 'Heartstopper's Kit Connor and Christopher Abbot. This is huge news for Marvel fans and promises an exciting new chapter for the X-Men franchise.

ON AIR – Which X-Men character do you think Sadie Sink or Adam Driver would be perfect for?

FILM · COMING SOON

3 The author of the Netflix hit 'The Polygamist' says women are seeing themselves reflected in her story.

Zimbabwean novelist Sue Nyathi self-funded her debut novel, which has now found a huge audience. It's a fantastic success story for an independent author.

ON AIR – Have you watched 'The Polygamist' on Netflix, and what did you think of it?

TV · NOW

4 Michael Sheen is investigating Wales' toxic legacy in a new documentary, looking into claims of cancer-causing chemicals being dumped across the country.

The Hollywood actor delves into a serious issue that has long affected Welsh communities. It's sure to be a powerful and important watch.

ON AIR – What do you think about celebrities like Michael Sheen using their platform to highlight important social issues?

TV · COMING SOON

5 Actress Bella Ramsey, known for 'The Last of Us', says she wishes she had been a more rebellious teenager.

Ramsey stars in a new film about a cancer survivor attending 'chemo camp' and finding freedom. It sounds like a really uplifting and inspiring story.

ON AIR – Do you ever look back at your teenage years and wish you'd been a bit more rebellious?

FILM · COMING SOON

On the schedule

1 **Great Britain's Amy Hunt has claimed her third gold medal at the European Athletics Championships, with Dina Asher-Smith making history.**

Hunt is on track for a historic quadruple, while Asher-Smith helped secure two relay golds for Team GB. It's been an incredible performance from the British athletes in Birmingham.

ON AIR – What's been your favourite moment from the European Athletics Championships so far?

ATHLETICS · UK

2 **Aston Villa are reportedly closing in on the signing of Parma goalkeeper Zion Suzuki, as Emi Martinez's future remains uncertain.**

This potential move suggests Villa are preparing for a change between the sticks. It's a big week for transfer news as the season approaches.

ON AIR – Aston Villa fans, how do you feel about the possibility of Emi Martinez leaving and Suzuki joining?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Bangladesh have pulled off one of Test cricket's greatest upsets, thrashing Australia by nine wickets in Darwin.**

The victory on the fourth day of the series-opener has sent shockwaves through the cricket world. It's a truly historic win for Bangladesh.

ON AIR – Was this one of the biggest upsets you've ever seen in Test cricket, or can you think of a bigger one?

CRICKET · GLOBAL

4 **Arsenal begin the new season as Premier League champions, but how difficult will it be for them to defend their title?**

They'll be facing tough competition from rivals looking to dethrone them. The Gunners will need to be at their best to retain the trophy.

ON AIR – Do you think Arsenal have what it takes to defend their Premier League title this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Britain's Arthur Fery has secured a win on his return at the Cincinnati Open, but Novak Djokovic suffered a shock defeat.**

Fery beat James Duckworth, while Djokovic fell to Argentina's Thiago Tirante. It's been an eventful start to the tournament for some of the sport's biggest names.

ON AIR – Who do you think will go all the way at the Cincinnati Open this year?

TENNIS · GLOBAL

Quick hits

- 1 A fascinating study reveals that watching nature documentaries can significantly reduce stress and anxiety levels.**
Researchers found that even short periods of viewing tranquil natural scenes, like flowing rivers or forest wildlife, had a noticeable calming effect on participants, lowering their heart rates and improving mood.
- 2 The delightful art of 'origami' is experiencing a quiet renaissance, with more people discovering its mindful benefits.**
Beyond just paper cranes, enthusiasts are exploring intricate designs, finding the precise folding process a wonderfully meditative way to unwind and unleash creativity.
- 3 New research suggests that a 'well-organised spice rack' might be a secret ingredient to a happier kitchen.**
It seems the simple act of having herbs and spices neatly arranged can reduce cooking-related stress and even inspire more adventurous culinary experiments.
- 4 A charming trend for 'homemade dog biscuits' is sweeping through pet-loving communities.**
Owners are enjoying baking healthy, tailor-made treats for their furry friends, often using wholesome ingredients like peanut butter and oats, and sharing recipes online.
- 5 Scientists have found that 'listening to the sound of rain' can help improve concentration and memory.**
The steady, non-intrusive sound creates a 'white noise' effect that masks distracting background sounds, allowing the brain to focus more effectively on tasks.
- 6 The simple joy of 'collecting interesting pebbles and stones' from walks is making a delightful comeback.**
From unusual shapes to striking colours, people are curating small collections, finding beauty in nature's artistry and a tangible memory of their outdoor adventures.
- 7 A quirky new study suggests that 'talking to your houseplants' might actually help them thrive.**
While the plants might not understand your words, the gentle vibrations and increased attention from their owners seem to contribute positively to their growth and wellbeing.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to decide if we need a coat, even if it's just for a quick trip outside?

ANSWER: POKING A HAND OUT THE DOOR, OR EVEN JUST 'SNIFFING' THE AIR!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh cup of coffee. What is it?

ANSWER: ADJUSTING THE MUG HANDLE TO FACE EXACTLY THE RIGHT WAY, EVERY SINGLE TIME!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you discover a 'quirky little museum' or local attraction that's completely off the beaten track but utterly brilliant?

What's the most unexpected hidden gem you've stumbled upon in the UK, and what made it so memorable?

- We all have those 'comfort foods' that instantly make us feel better, don't we, especially on a chilly evening?

What's your ultimate British comfort food, the one dish that always hits the spot, and why is it so special to you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** Did you know that the world's first ever postage stamp, the 'Penny Black', was issued in the United Kingdom in 1840?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It's said that during the Great Fire of London in 1666, a baker managed to save his entire stock of bread by burying it in his garden, only for it to be perfectly preserved and edible months later.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£4.3 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£4.3 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The longest place name in the United Kingdom is Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwlllantysiliogogogoch, a village in Wales.
- The official residence of the British monarch in London, Buckingham Palace, has 775 rooms.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The famous black cabs in London are officially known as Hackney Carriages.
- The Union Jack, the national flag of the United Kingdom, combines the flags of England, Scotland, and Northern Ireland.
- The world's first public park, Birkenhead Park, opened in Merseyside in 1847 and inspired New York's Central Park.
- The iconic red telephone boxes were designed by Sir Giles Gilbert Scott, who also designed Battersea Power Station.
- The River Thames in England is home to over 120 species of fish.

On this day

Day 229 of the year, 136 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Saint Beatrice of Silva; Christian feast day: Saint Clare of Montefalco; Christian feast day: Elias of Enna; Christian feast day: Saint Hyacinth of Poland. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1982 — Mark Salling, American actor and musician (died 2018)
- 1954 — Eric Johnson, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1988 — Joyner Lucas, American rapper
- 1991 — Austin Butler, American actor
- 1950 — Geraint Jarman, Welsh musician, poet and television producer (died 2025)
- 1958 — Belinda Carlisle, American singer-songwriter
- 1969 — Kelvin Mercer, American rapper, songwriter and producer
- 1934 — Ron Henry, English footballer (died 2014)

THE DAY TODAY

- 2005 — The first forced evacuation of settlers, as part of Israeli disengagement from Gaza, starts.
- 1970 — Soviet Union Venera program: Venera 7 launched. It will become the first spacecraft to successfully transmit data from the surface of another planet (Venus).
- 1977 — The Soviet icebreaker Arktika becomes the first surface ship to reach the North Pole.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2004 — The National Assembly of Serbia unanimously adopts new state symbols for Serbia: Bože pravde becomes the new anthem and the coat of arms is adopted for the whole country.
- 1959 — Quake Lake is formed by the magnitude 7.2 1959 Hebgen Lake earthquake near Hebgen Lake in Montana.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2008 — American swimmer Michael Phelps becomes the first person to win eight gold medals at one Olympic Games.
- 2005 — Over 500 bombs are set off by terrorists at 300 locations in 63 out of the 64 districts of Bangladesh.

- 2017 — Barcelona attacks: A van is driven into pedestrians in La Rambla, killing 14 and injuring at least 100.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 230 of the year, 135 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Agapitus of Palestrina; Christian feast day: Alberto Hurtado; Christian feast day: Daig of Inniskeen; Christian feast day: Evan (or Inan). Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1952 — Patrick Swayze, American actor and dancer (died 2009)
- 1969 — Masta Killa, American rapper
- 1957 — Denis Leary, American comedian, actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1957 — Tan Dun, Chinese composer
- 1995 — Parker McKenna Posey, American actress
- 1962 — Adam Storke, American actor
- 1939 — Maxine Brown, American soul/R&B singer-songwriter
- 1945 — Sarah Dash, American singer-songwriter and actress (died 2021)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2008 — The President of Pakistan, Pervez Musharraf, resigns under threat of impeachment.
- 1945 — Sukarno takes office as the first president of Indonesia, following the country's declaration of independence the previous day.
- 1989 — Leading presidential hopeful Luis Carlos Galán is assassinated near Bogotá in Colombia.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2003 — One-year-old Zachary Turner is murdered in Newfoundland by his mother, who was awarded custody despite facing trial for the murder of Zachary's father. The case was documented in the film Dear Zachary and led to reform of Canada's bail laws.
- 1966 — Vietnam War: The Battle of Long Tan ensues after a patrol from the 6th Battalion, Royal Australian Regiment clashes with a Viet Cong force in Phước Tuy Province.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

22–23

Belgian Grand Prix (F1)